Teaching notes

Answers

Task 1

Pitfall trap: ground beetle, centipede, woodlouse

Pooter: shield bug, ladybird larvae

Sweep net: meadow brown butterfly, grasshopper, damselfly

Task 2

Mist net: swallows and house martins, wading birds, finches

Dart: elephant, tiger, rhino

Longworth trap: field mouse, bank vole

Task 3

Sound: bats, nightingale, bittern

Soft clay: otter, mink, water vole

Camera trap: Asiatic golden cat, pygmy hippo

There is a PDF of accompanying photographs for each task. Students could cut them up or they could be given pre-cut sets to save time.

- Students could be asked to match the name with the methods of capture and animal pictures.
- Ask students to describe the capture methods by looking at the photos and to suggest the type of animals they could be used to catch.
- The photographs could be used as an alternative to the text based tasks.
- For a more challenging task students could be given all three sets of photographs and asked to sort them into groups according to the best methods of capture and identification (students will notice some overlap here which would lead to discussion). Ask students to explain their choices.

To study a habitat or ecosystem you have to know which animals are living there. Ecologists use **keys** to help them identify different organisms. But first they must capture the animals.

Task 1

Cut out the invertebrates and match them to the best method of capture.

pitfall trap	**pooter**	**sweep net**

ladybird larvae	grasshopper	meadow brown butterfly	woodlouse
ground beetle	shield bug	centipede	damselfly

Task 2

How do scientists capture larger animals?

mist net	**dart with immobilising drug**	**Longworth trap**

Cut out the vertebrates and match with the best method of capture for them.

African elephants	swallows and house martins	Indian rhinoceros	bank vole
finches	Siberian tiger	field mouse	wading birds

Task 3

Some animals can be identified without capture. Which animals would these methods be suitable for? Cut out the animals out match to the best method to use to identify them.

sound	**camera trap (heat and motion sensitive)**	**soft clay (for footprints)**

pygmy hippopotamus	water vole	Pipistrelle bat
mink	Daubenton's bat	Asiatic golden cat
bittern	otter	nightingale